

3. University Legislation

The University's Legislation addresses matters of institutional governance and organisation. As defined in the University Statutes, University Legislation consists of the Charter, Statutes, Ordinances, Regulations and Codes of Practice of the University. All members of staff and students are subject to University Legislation.

Whilst the Charter and Statutes are at the top of this hierarchy and address matters of institutional governance and organisation, and the Ordinances provide more detail on the exercise of powers than in the Statutes, most students are affected directly by Regulations and Codes of Practice, which contain principles and standards designed to control or govern conduct, or provide direction.

University Legislation: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/registry/legislation> ➞

Expand all

University Regulations



The University Regulations contain principles and standards designed to control or govern conduct or provide direction at a more detailed level than Ordinances. These Regulations apply to all members of the University, including students.

There are nine different sections of University Regulations, in addition to **Library Regulations** ➞. These nine sections are described, and available to view, on the **University Regulations Intranet page** ➞.

Please note that these Regulations are subject to being modified during the academic session. The University has reserved the right to make changes, as appropriate, which bind all members of the University, including students.

Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance



Supplementing the Regulations, there are a number of academic and academic-related Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance documents. These documents set out the procedures to be followed in specific areas, and failure to comply can result in disciplinary action.

Please visit the **[Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance Intranet page](#)**  to find out more information, including viewing the documents.

Please note that these documents are subject to being modified during the academic session. The University has reserved the right to make changes, as appropriate, which bind all members of the University, including students.



Cohort Legislation



The University introduced 'cohort legislation' in 2017-18. This means that the legislation that applies to you, as a student, will depend upon the year in which you started your studies (i.e. your cohort):

- If you entered the first year of your Programme in the 2024-25 academic session you will be subject to the 2024-25 legislation. This means the **[2024-25 Regulations](#)**  and **[2024-25 Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance](#)**  will apply to you for the duration of your Programme of study
- If you entered the first year of your Programme in the 2025-26 academic session you will be subject to the 2025-26 legislation. This means the **[2025-26 Regulations](#)**  and **[2025-26 Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance](#)**  will apply to you for the duration of your Programme of study

Please note, if you are entering directly into a later year of a Programme, or transferring from one Programme to another, you will normally be subject to the same legislation as other students in your year. For example, if you enter directly into the 2nd year of a Programme in 2025-26 you will normally be subject to the 2024-25 legislation, so that you are subject to the same legislation as the majority of your peers (who will have entered in the 2024-25 academic session).

If you have any queries about which legislation applies to you, or any other general queries about legislation, please contact your School, or alternatively email: **legislationqueries@contacts.bham.ac.uk**

Legislation Applicable to All Years of Entry



Students also need to be aware of, and will be expected to comply with, various University-wide Policies and Guidance documents, which are updated from time to time, and apply to every student no matter on their year of entry (i.e. they are not cohort specific).

These include, but are not limited to:

- **University Health and Safety Policies** .
- **Data Protection Policy**. .
- **Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy**. .
- IT Services Policies and Procedures.
- Equality, Diversity and Inclusion Policies.



Updates to Legislation



University Legislation may need to be amended, either to reflect external requirements (for example, those of professional or accrediting bodies) or because a change to policy or practice has been agreed. Consideration is always given to whether any proposed change should apply to all legislation or to a specific cohort, and students will normally be consulted about or informed of the change, depending on its nature. Information is published when any significant changes are made to University Legislation.

Student Charter



The Student Charter, jointly developed by students and staff, outlines the standards and core principles of our learning community. It applies to all registered students of the University following Taught or Research Programmes, whether studying on or off campus.

Student Charter: <https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/study/applicants/student-charter> 

Extenuating Circumstances



During your period of study any number of circumstances may affect your ability to perform well in assessments (for example: essays, presentations, oral examinations, class tests and examinations).

"Extenuating circumstances" is the process of informing your School of circumstances that have affected you during the year. Depending upon the nature and severity of these circumstances your School may wish to take them into account when the Board of Examiners meets to decide what your progress decision should be.

To ensure that details of your extenuating circumstances are handled with the utmost sensitivity, privacy and confidentiality, discussions about the validity of requests for extenuating circumstances will take place at Extenuating Circumstances Panels (held after each University assessment period, to ensure that requests for extenuating circumstances are considered in a timely manner) rather than at the full meeting of the Board of Examiners (held at the end of the academic year). The Board of Examiners will not discuss details of the extenuating circumstances you present.

Further information, including information on how to present extenuating circumstances, can be found on the **extenuating circumstances pages**. 



Academic Appeals



The academic appeals process allows you to appeal against a progress decision from the Board of Examiners. You are only able to appeal against a progress decision (e.g. resits, failing your course, being granted an alternative qualification) or degree classification. This process is right for you if:

- You want to challenge a progress decision you received at the end of a module or programme of study, either because you think that something demonstrably went wrong with the University's procedures or because you had difficulties that the University didn't know about (and you have good reason for not having submitted extenuating circumstances at the appropriate time).
- If you are a Postgraduate Research student, you may also appeal if you feel that there has been bias in the assessment of your thesis on the part of one or more of the examiners.

Your progress decision will be made available to you after your marks have been confirmed by the Board of Examiners. You may only appeal once the progress decision has been published on the **Student Gateway**. 

Further information about academic appeals can be found on the **academic appeals pages** 

Student Complaints



The complaints process covers situations in which you are unsatisfied with your experience at the University or with the services it provides. This process is right for you if:

- You have a concern or complaint about programmes, modules, services or facilities provided by the University
- You have a complaint about action, or lack of action, by the University or its staff.

The complaints process covers both informal and more formal stages of complaint. The complaints process can't provide academic redress (i.e. challenging a progress decision).

Further information about student complaints is available on the [student complaints pages](#).  There is also information on this page for students who wish to raise a concern or make a complaint about another student.



Student Conduct and Fitness to Practise



The University of Birmingham is a great place to live and study, and we want you to have an enjoyable and safe time as a member of a diverse University community. As a student of the University of Birmingham you are required at all times to conduct yourself in an appropriate manner in your day-to-day activities, including in your dealings with other students, staff, and external organisations.

During your time as a student, we expect you to behave:

- Safely, and with regard to the safety of others
- With civility, consideration and respect for others
- In accordance with University policies, rules and regulations, and all applicable laws

You have a responsibility to treat all members of the University community with respect and represent the University as responsible ambassadors through your good conduct on and off campus. This applies anywhere and at any time but is particularly important whilst on campus, on fieldwork or placement, on other study away from the University, on the sports field, or whilst engaged in any other University of Birmingham-related activity.

Good conduct means:

- Recognising the diversity of the University community and not discriminating against others
- Being honest, considerate, and courteous towards others

- Behaving in a respectful manner towards others so that they do not feel that they are being harassed, bullied, or coerced, whether within or outside the University
- Acting responsibly and showing respect for University property
- Acting within the law and not engaging in any activity or behaviour that is likely to bring the University into disrepute

Examples of unacceptable behaviour include:

- Violence against another person (including threats to hurt)
- Indecent, threatening, intimidating or offensive behaviour or language (including that of a sexualised nature)
- Bullying and harassment
- Abusive comments (including those that relate to sex, religion, sexuality, and race), whether in person or online
- Sexual misconduct (including unwanted touching, kissing, sexual acts or unwanted sexual intercourse)
- Possessing, supplying or selling any controlled drug or psychoactive substance (such as cannabis, LSD, cocaine, MDMA) on University property
- Significant damage to University property or property of other students, staff or visitors to the University
- Unauthorised use of University property
- Disruption of University activities (including lectures, meetings, sporting and social activities)
- Contempt of the University's disciplinary authorities
- Falsification of University documentation or documents in relation to the University
- Impersonation of others in connection with the University
- Acts of bribery such as an offer or inducement to influence another in their duties
- Misuse of IT facilities
- Persistent minor offences
- Receiving a criminal conviction
- Academic Misconduct (serious plagiarism and examination irregularities)

Unacceptable behaviour can take place in person as well as via social media.

Students registered on Fitness to Practise programmes may have further obligations placed on them with regard to their expected behaviour.

What is harassment?

Harassment is any behaviour that is unwanted and could reasonably be considered as violating a person's dignity or creating an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment.



Behaviour amounting to harassment may include:

- Unwelcome sexual advances
- Inappropriate or unnecessary physical contact, including invasion of personal space and inappropriate touching
- Sexually explicit language, jokes, verbal and physical innuendo
- Using demeaning, gender-specific terminology
- Display or circulation of sexually explicit materials
- Coercive demands for sexual favours
- Inappropriate comments about a person's appearance, intrusive questions, comments or remarks about a person's private life and malicious gossip.
Pestering, spying or stalking
- Physical assault or threats of physical assault
- Insults, name-calling and offensive language and gestures
- Ridiculing and undermining behaviour
- Intimidating, coercive or threatening actions and behaviour
- Isolation, non-cooperation or deliberate exclusion.

Sexual harassment can take many different forms including those outlined above, from inappropriate language to sexual assault. There doesn't need to have been physical contact for sexual harassment to have taken place.

If you have been affected by sexual harassment or assault, the matter can be reported to the police. Further information about your options is available on the Report and Support webpage.

How can I avoid misunderstandings?

It is important that all parties agree to sexual activity. To avoid any doubt at all about whether or not another person is agreeing to sexual activity:

- You should ask them
- Check the other person's body language
- STOP - If someone seems drunk or under the influence of drink or drugs, is asleep or unconscious, or you're not sure, you must wait until they are awake and sober and ask them again
- REMEMBER – the other person can change their mind at any time – you must respect their choice and STOP

How does the University of Birmingham deal with alleged misconduct?

If the matter has been reported to the police, you can email Student Conduct, Complaints and Appeals (conduct@contacts.bham.ac.uk) with details of:

- the student who has been reported,
- the date and place the incident occurred, and
- the Crime Reference Number.

When we receive this information, the University will check it and consider if precautionary measures need to be put in place for the protection of all parties involved.

The University would not normally investigate the same matter at the same time as the police. However, if the police investigation results in a formal police outcome (such as a caution) or a conviction by a court, the University can continue or start disciplinary action against the student concerned. At the end of a police investigation, you may want to make a formal complaint to the University for the purpose of initiating an internal disciplinary investigation. You should only submit a formal complaint form once the police have confirmed that its investigation has concluded.

- In circumstances where there is a criminal investigation, the University may be required to disclose information to the police. Where this is the case, the University would consider whether the information should be released, and may discuss the request with the student concerned.
- In serious cases the University can take precautionary action whilst an investigation is ongoing. Precautionary action can include temporarily suspending a student from the University or temporarily restricting their access to certain premises or facilities.
- There are differences between criminal investigations and University investigations. Under the criminal process, the allegations will be treated as a potential criminal offence. Under the University misconduct process, the University would determine whether a student has breached the University's Regulations. The University cannot determine whether or not a criminal offence has occurred.
- The University may investigate conduct occurring in relation to a course, conduct on campus, fieldwork, placements or study abroad and exchange programmes, on social media or whilst engaged in any other University-related activity. The University may investigate conduct irrespective of where it occurs. Where the matter is not under police investigation, students can submit a formal complaint to Student Conduct, Complaints and Appeals. by submitting a '[Complaints about other Students' form](#)'. Please be aware that the University's student disciplinary procedures are intended to address misconduct by students rather than resolve disputes between individuals. Incidents which are not a potential disciplinary offence will not be investigated. Further guidance about making a complaint about another student and the process followed is available in the '[Raising a concern or complaint about another student](#)' section of the [Student Complaints webpage](#).

- If there is sufficient evidence, misconduct can be dealt with by way of a low-level sanction (by issuing a formal written warning, community service, or an agreement as to future behaviour or to engage with appropriate support) or by referring the matter to a College Misconduct and Fitness to Practise Committee, depending on the seriousness of the alleged offence or other circumstances of the case, such as alleged repeated misconduct.

The University investigation process is an evidence-based process and decisions are made on the balance of probabilities, which means we would be looking at whether the evidence indicates that it is more likely than not that a breach of Regulations has occurred. If the University determines that no further action can be taken it does not mean that the University is questioning whether or not a student is telling the truth, it normally means that there is insufficient evidence which can be used in misconduct proceedings to adequately support the suggestion that there has been a breach of University Regulations.

If misconduct is found proven, a range of sanctions could be applied by a College Misconduct and Fitness to Practise Committee which range from a formal written warning, restricting access to certain University facilities, suspension from the University, or withdrawal from the University (with or without an award). For academic offences, sanctions could also include those which will have an impact on assessment marks, module marks, and degree classification. In some circumstances, the sanction imposed will mean that the student will not be eligible to receive a Degree from the University. However, each case is decided by the Committee with due regard for the particular circumstances, taking into consideration all of the evidence including any relevant aggravating factors or mitigating circumstances of the student.

Information about Student Conduct and Fitness to Practise is available on the [Student Conduct webpage](#) .

Social Media



The University has expectations of students when using social media, particularly where they have identified themselves as a University of Birmingham student or where their communication is in relation to a programme of study or extra-curricular activity.

You are expected:

- To consider others' feelings when adding content, commenting or distributing content made by others
- To respect others' freedom of speech and abide by the University's Code of Practice on Freedom of Speech
- To provide feedback in relation to the programme of study and the University through appropriate channels e.g. through surveys, Student Reps and the Guild of Students
- To follow the principles of Academic Freedom as defined in Ordinance 3.18

You should not use social media to add or distribute material or content that:

- Is defamatory – which is defined as the communication of a statement that makes a false claim, expressly stated or implied to be factual, that may harm the reputation of someone or something
- Could be considered to be harassment or bullying, whether directed towards another University student, a member of University staff or a member of the public
- Uses phrases or language which could be considered to be abusive, hateful, sexist, racist, homophobic or discriminatory
- Includes information on matters relating to staff or fellow students without their permission
- Includes photographs, images or recordings of members of staff or students, without their permission, or that could be considered embarrassing or abusive.

You should note that your behaviour on social media is covered by the **University's Legislation** .

You need to be aware that comments on social media may result in Civil or Criminal Legal action.

Academic Misconduct and Examinations



Every year a number of students are subject to investigations because of an alleged examination irregularity. Examination irregularities are investigated by Student Conduct, Complaints and Appeals under the Code of Practice on Academic Integrity. Following an investigation, when a decision has been made that an Examination Irregularity has occurred cases may be referred to an academic member of staff (an Examination Irregularity Officer) to decide on a sanction or in serious cases, to a College Misconduct and Fitness to Practise Committee. This could result in the student concerned having their examination mark reduced to zero (with no resit), or in severe cases, the student being withdrawn from the University with no award.

What is an Examination Irregularity?

An examination irregularity occurs if you breach University Regulations relating to academic conduct. Examination irregularities could include:

- Taking notes into an examination
- Using or being in possession of a phone, a smart watch or other non-permitted electronic devices, e.g. having a phone in your pocket – these should be left in the designated area in the examination venue
- Annotations (written notes/images or calculations) in books/dictionaries
- Having writing on your body/arms/hands during an examination
- Arranging for somebody else to take your exam on your behalf

- Taking an exam on the behalf of another student
- Obtaining, accessing or attempting to obtain or access an unseen assessment
- Talking to or communicating with others
- Causing a disturbance
- Copying from another student
- Storing text in calculators or other electronic devices
- Removing papers from the exam room
- Taking blank paper into an examination
- Taking correction tape or fluid (Tippex) into the examination.



Why does the University of Birmingham take Examination Irregularities seriously?

The University maintains high standards. Examination irregularities can:

- Give a student an unfair advantage
- Disadvantage other students who act fairly
- Impact on the credibility of the University and your degree

What are the rules and regulations for online examinations and assessments?

The University Regulations regarding examinations apply to online examinations and assessments. These rules apply during the period of each examination. For instance, if the examination takes place over 24 hours, such as from 10am one day until 10am the next day, this is the examination period, not the one or two hours during which you will take your own examination. In particular:

- You should conduct these exams as you would if the examinations were being sat on campus
- You must not communicate or attempt to communicate with anyone during the period of the exam (from before you have started, and after you have finished your own examination)

This means that:

- You must not share information about the content of the examination questions, with other students or other third parties, whether this be in person or electronically (including by social media, gaming, or other similar platforms)
- You must not share your answers with other students or third parties, whether this be in person or electronically (including by social media, gaming, or other similar platforms)

- You must not discuss the contents of the examination/assessment with others or collaborate with other students or third parties in the writing or drafting of answers
- You must not save, replay, post, or take screenshots of examination questions or suggested answers on social media, gaming platforms or similar
- You must not copy or attempt to copy from another student's work
- You must not be involved in any arrangement whereby another party undertakes the assessment on your behalf
- You must not obtain or access, or attempt to obtain or access, an unseen assessment, except where this has been expressly agreed with the Principal Academic Unit
- Any work you submit must be your own work – you must not use generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) or online/automatic solvers, unless specifically permitted
- You must not access non-permitted materials when undertaking the assessment



If you have any concerns about another student's conduct during an examination, you should contact your school in the first instance. Similarly, if you have a question about the examination (e.g., you are concerned there is an error), you should contact your school.

How can I avoid committing an examination irregularity during an in-person and invigilated examination that takes place on campus?

Before an on-campus exam you are advised to:

- Check the location of your exam in advance, since the venue may be in an unfamiliar place.
- Remove any annotations, notes, paper, or post-it notes from texts: check your dictionaries, statute books or other permitted texts to ensure that they are clean. If you have more than one copy, only take the clean copy to the exam.
- If you are permitted to take a calculator into your exam, delete any stored items. Check with the Module Leader for the examination whether you are allowed a calculator in the exam, and what type of calculator you are allowed to use.
- Put permitted stationery in a transparent pencil case: Pens, pencils and other permitted stationery items need to be in a transparent pencil case or clear plastic bag. Remove any correction tape/fluid and notes from your pencil case as you cannot take these into an exam.
- Dress appropriately for the exam: some venues may feel warm and others may feel cooler, so consider wearing layers of clothing as you will not be allowed to wear a coat, jacket or scarf in the exam.
- Wear a simple (non-smart) wristwatch: if you think you may have problems seeing the clocks in the examination hall wear a wristwatch, as you won't be allowed to use your mobile phone to check the time.
- Arrive at the exam hall early - give yourself time to sort out your belongings and go to the toilet before you go into the exam hall.
- Listen to the Invigilator's announcements before you go into the exam hall – they are there to help you.

In the exam venue, before the exam starts:

- Put your belongings in the designated area: This includes any scarfs, hats, caps, coats or jackets. You are not allowed to keep your coat / jacket on the back of your chair.
- Make sure any phones or smart watches are completely switched off (not just on 'Airplane Mode', 'Flight Mode' or 'Do not Disturb') and place them under your desk or in a designated area (as instructed by the invigilators).
- Make sure that your hands/arms are clean and have no writing on them: if you have writing on your person, you MUST tell the Invigilator before the examination starts. Do not write on yourself during the exam.
- Check your pockets: make sure you do not have any not permitted items, such as revision notes, papers, your phone, or any device that access or store information. If you do have something in your pockets that is not permitted or you are unsure about, you must tell the Invigilator before the exam starts.
- Listen carefully to the Invigilator's instructions.

During the exam:

- Raise your hand if there is a problem during the exam (for example, you cannot see the clock): the Invigilator will come to speak to you and support you with any issues.
- Inform the Invigilator if you realise you have something on you that should not be permitted: you will usually be able to continue the exam but they may ask you some questions.
- Speak to the Invigilator if you are concerned about another student's behaviour in the exam.

Additional exam tips:

- Try to get some rest and sleep before your exam.
- Allow plenty of time to travel to and find the venue, especially if it's somewhere you haven't been before.
- Have your pens, pencils, ID card and permitted equipment ready before going into the exam.

Where can I get help?

If you are anxious, stressed, or feeling ill, you may want to access support, which is available from Wellbeing Officers in your School or College, as well as support available from Your Wellbeing.

Exam Rules: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/registry/exams/rules> 

Exam and Assessment Guidance: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/registry/exams/rules/guidance-for-online-examinations-and-assessments.aspx> 

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism



Plagiarism can occur in all types of assessment when a student claims as their own, intentionally or by omission, work which was not done by that student. This may occur in a number of ways e.g. copying and pasting material, adapting material and self-plagiarism. Submitting work and assessments created by someone or something else, as if it was your own, is plagiarism and is a form of academic misconduct. This includes Artificial Intelligence (AI)-generated content and content written by a third party (e.g. a company, other person, or a friend or family member) and fabricating data.



The University of Birmingham provides guidance on plagiarism. Guidance can be found on the [Plagiarism webpage](#) and the [library referencing page](#).

The following information on plagiarism should only be viewed as general guidance. For up-to-date guidance please see the hyperlink above.

What is plagiarism?

Examples of plagiarism are:

- Cutting / copying and pasting material from the online sources.
- Copying the work of another student (past or present) including essay material, laboratory data or computer code.
- Copying course material or lecture notes.
- Copying material from a textbook or journal.
- Resubmitting your own work (in full or part) that you have already submitted for another assignment (“self-plagiarism” or “auto-plagiarism”).
- Collusion – when two or more students work together in preparing a piece of work (which could be an online exam, a timed essay, or other types of assessment) that is submitted as individual work. This does not include collaboration as part of group work.
- Fabrication or misrepresentation – claiming to have done work that you haven’t done, either negligently or by false or misleading representation of evidence, results or data.
- Commissioning work / buying essays & Software / using generative AI – submitting any part of an assessment that has not been done by the student, and which has either been bought from an essay writing company / website; downloaded from an essay



repository; or prepared / generated by someone or something other than the student, would normally constitute a deliberate attempt to deceive the marker.

- Unacceptable proof-reading / editorial assistance – rewriting or editing of text with the purpose of improving the student's research arguments, or contributing new arguments, or rewriting computer code, is not acceptable, whether undertaken by a person, by generative AI or by any other means, and may be deemed to be plagiarism.

Generative AI

The University's position on use of Generative AI is set out below. The instructions for your assessment should inform you about whether or not you can use Generative AI in preparing the assessment. If you are unclear on this, you should ask the Module Lead. The usual position on the use of Generative AI is:

- Generative AI or other editorial assistance must not be used to:
 - Alter text to clarify and / or develop the ideas, arguments, and explanations.
 - Correct the accuracy of the information.
 - Develop or change the ideas and arguments presented.
 - Translate text into, or from, the language being studied, or for the purpose of reducing the length of the submission so as to comply with a word limit requirement.
- Generative AI or other editorial assistance may only be used to offer advice and guidance on:
 - Correcting spelling and punctuation.
 - Ensuring text follows the conventions of grammar and syntax in written English.
 - Shortening long sentences or reducing long paragraphs without changes to the overall content.
 - Ensuring the consistency, formatting and ordering of page numbers, headers and footers, and footnotes and endnotes.
 - Improving the positioning of tables and figures and the clarity, grammar, spelling and punctuation of any text in table or figure legends.

Plagiarism is a serious matter for the University. If you are found to have plagiarised, a sanction may be imposed, which could range from a mark reduction, you not being able to obtain the credits in a module and even withdrawal from the University.

Your responsibility regarding plagiarism

It is important that you make sure you understand plagiarism and how to avoid it. If you need further information you should speak to your Personal Academic Tutor or the module leader for the assessment you are working on. There are resources available at the

University which can be found on the **Academic Integrity: support and advice webpages** .

You are expected to submit work that demonstrates compliance with two important prerequisites:

- a level of independent thought, grounded in the teaching received.
- the provision of clear referencing to all sources consulted, both within the main body of the work submitted and in any separate listing of sources.

It should be clear from a consideration of these two key requirements why plagiarism is unacceptable. By definition, a piece of work that has been plagiarised will never be able to meet either of the above criteria. Asking yourself prior to submission whether your work passes both tests is a useful method for determining whether there is likely to be a problem with plagiarism.

The University has the Code of Practice on Academic Integrity which covers all assessments, including conduct in exams and class tests and plagiarism. There is also guidance to accompany the Code of Practice. Both documents can be found on the **Codes of Practice, Policies and Guidance**  pages.

Degree Classifications, Degree Outcomes Statement, and External Advisors on Standards



The UK Standing Committee for Quality Assessment (UKSCQA) has published a **Statement of Intent**  proposing that every higher education provider across England produce and publish a Degree Outcomes Statement analysing their degree classification profile and articulating the results of an internal review in the context of their arrangements for teaching, learning and assessment of students, academic regulations, and academic governance.

The University of Birmingham's Degree Outcomes Statement is available on the **Quality Assurance and Enhancement webpage**  and contains high-level information on how degrees are calculated and classified, amongst other valuable information.

The Statement of Intent also recommended that an institution's governing body incorporates external assurance of the Degree Outcomes Statement and suggests appointing a dedicated external advisor on degree classifications. The University has therefore appointed two External Advisors on Academic Standards; one to scrutinise Undergraduate standards and the other to scrutinise Postgraduate Taught standards. These are senior academic roles providing external scrutiny, quality assurance and advice in relation to the University's ongoing review of degree classifications and academic outcomes for students. The roles complement and enhance the work already undertaken by subject- and programme-level External Examiners in setting and maintaining academic standards and providing external assurance of the quality of the University's awards.

General Data Protection Regulation and Student Privacy Notice



The University of Birmingham needs to keep certain information about its employees, students and other users to allow it to monitor performance, achievements, and health and safety. It also needs to process information, for example so that staff can be recruited, paid, courses organised and also to ensure legal obligations to funding bodies and government are complied with. To comply with the law, information must be collected and used fairly, stored safely and not be disclosed to any other person unlawfully. To do this, the University must comply with the Data Protection Principles set out in the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and other data protection laws.



The **University's student privacy notice**  provides information about how the University uses your personal data while you are a student at the University of Birmingham. It is important that, as a student, you review, in full, the information on this page so you are aware how the University will use your personal data.

Within the student privacy notice you will see that your data is shared with only those University staff who need access for the purpose of delivering our academic and non-academic services and facilities. Your personal data is also shared with a range of external organisations as is necessary for the purposes set out on the student privacy notice and as permitted or required by law. For example, this may include the following:

- The providers of any external or collaborative learning and training placements or fieldwork opportunities (we will explain to you how and when this will be shared when we collect the data from you).
- Any relevant professional or statutory regulatory bodies (for example, the General Medical Council); we will tell you in what circumstances we share data with these organisations.

If you have any queries relating to how your data is processed or shared please speak with your School in the first instance.

